From Scattered Notes to a Shared Picture

The family's plan for organizing Dad's situation: eight actions, in order, with a line for who takes each and by when.

The goal: one current, written picture of Dad's situation that the whole family recognizes, with the open questions marked instead of guessed.

This is a list to share, so that anyone willing to help can see which part could be theirs. Write a name and a day beside each action, and tick it off when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Write down where Dad is living or staying right now, and who helps him there.			
2. Describe how his day goes now: morning, daytime, evening and overnight, and who is there for each part.			
3. List the family members and professionals involved, with a phone number or email for each.			
4. Beside each name, write what that person actually does. Ask them; don't go by what everyone assumes.			
5. Ask the person who helps Dad most which responsibilities are becoming difficult. Write down what they say, in their words.			
6. Gather the care notes that already exist, such as a visit summary, a caregiver's notebook or a calendar, with Dad's permission.			
7. Go through everything you've collected and mark each line: a confirmed fact, something the family has seen, or a question nobody has answered.			
8. Go over what you've written with Dad, where possible, and then with the family. Where someone sees it differently, add their version beside yours.			

Two things to settle along the way

- Who the family's contact is for now, so the people calling have one number to try.
- Which decisions are coming up, with any date someone has given and who gave it.

You're done when

The family has a current written picture of Dad's situation, one person named as the contact, and a list of the decisions coming up, with everything you don't know marked “not yet known.” What comes after that, a professional's review and any decision about Dad's care, isn't on this list, because it isn't the family's to do alone.

While you work through it

- A line that says “not yet known” is a finished line. Don't fill a gap by guessing.
- If two people remember something differently, write both versions down. Settling it isn't on this list.
- This plan is for organizing. A question about Dad's health goes to his doctor or nurse when it comes up, and an emergency goes to emergency services.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. It doesn't certify that Dad is safe where he is, decide anything about his care or treatment, or stand in for the professional review it prepares you for.

Ready for the next step?

You've turned scattered notes into a picture the family shares, with the unknowns marked. The care interview goes through that picture with you, area by area, checks what's been left out, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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